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Low power management for sleep mode operation of a memory device

Abstract

In a memory sub-system, causing a standby circuit associated with a memory device to enter into a low power mode. In the low power mode, causing a reference voltage to be supplied to a voltage regulator, wherein the reference voltage causes the voltage regulator to supply a standby current level to the memory device, where the standby current level is lower than a current level supplied when the memory device is in an active mode.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/426,963, filed on Jul. 29, 2021, which is a National Stage

Application filed pursuant to 35 USC 371 based on PCT/CN2020/138229, filed on Dec. 22, 2020. The entireties of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/426,963 and PCT/CN2020/138229 are hereby incorporated by reference herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the disclosure relate generally to memory sub-systems, and more specifically, low power mode management for sleep mode operation of a memory device.

BACKGROUND

(2) A memory sub-system can include one or more memory devices that store data. The memory devices can be, for example, non-volatile memory devices and volatile memory devices. In general, a host system can utilize a memory sub-system to store data at the memory devices and to retrieve data from the memory devices.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The present disclosure will be understood more fully from the detailed description given below and from the accompanying drawings of various embodiments of the disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates an example computing environment that includes a memory sub-system in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a memory device in communication with a memory sub-system controller of a memory sub-system, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates an example low power mode management component associated with a memory sub-system in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 4 a flow diagram of an example method associated with supplying a standby current level to a memory device in a low power mode of an idle state in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating operating states of a memory sub-system in a low power mode with a secondary power supply powered on, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating operating states of a memory sub-system in a low power mode with a secondary power supply powered off, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a block diagram of an example computer system in which embodiments of the present disclosure may operate.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (9) Aspects of the present disclosure relate to low power mode management for sleep mode operation of a memory device in a memory sub-system. A memory sub-system can be a storage device, a memory module, or a hybrid of a storage device and memory module. Examples of storage devices and memory modules are described below in conjunction with FIG. 1. In general, a host system can utilize a memory sub-system that includes one or more components, such as memory devices that store data. The host system can provide data to be stored at the memory sub-system and can request data to be retrieved from the memory sub-system.
- (10) A memory sub-system can include high density non-volatile memory devices where retention of data is desired when no power is supplied to the memory device. One example of non-volatile memory devices is a not-and (NAND) memory device. Other examples of non-volatile memory devices are described below in conjunction with FIG. 1. A non-volatile memory device is a package of one or more memory dies. Each die can consist of one or more planes. For some types of non-volatile memory devices (e.g., NAND devices), each plane consists of a set of physical blocks.

Each block consists of a set of pages. Each page consists of a set of memory cells (“cells”). A cell is an electronic device or unit that stores information. Depending on the cell type, a cell can store one or more bits of binary information, and has various logic states that correlate to the number of bits being stored. The logic states can be represented by binary values, such as “0” and “1”, or combinations of such values.

(11) A memory sub-system can have multiple power states (PS) which are grouped as either an active power state (e.g., Power State 0) or an idle power state (e.g., Power State 4). In an example, a memory sub-system can have a deep idle power state representing a “sleep” mode (e.g., Power State 4). This lowest idle state (herein referred to as a “sleep state” or “sleep mode operation”) in a memory sub-system is typically achieved by turning off most hardware logic, memory components, non-volatile memory, and an internal power supply of the memory sub-system. For example, when the memory sub-system enters the sleep state, power to components of the memory sub-system can be turned off to minimize power consumption (e.g., a level of power or energy generated by a power supply) while in the sleep or deep idle state. In view of the loss of power, nonvolatile memory configuration information is lost. After the memory-sub system exits the deep idle state by turning on the power supply again, the memory sub-system needs to initialize the non-volatile memory to restore the configuration information, so non-volatile can perform normal operations.

(12) Initializing non-volatile memory can cause a negative impact to command response time and input/output (IO) performance of the memory sub-system. Initializing non-volatile memory also consumes power, and frequent transitions to and from the sleep mode increases overall power consumption contributing to performance issues (e.g., shorter power supply (e.g., battery) operation time when the memory component is employed on a mobile platform). In addition, frequent power state transitions to the sleep state increases the number of initialization operations to non-volatile memory and produces a negative impact to an endurance of the memory sub-system.

(13) Typical memory sub-system behavior shows a significant number of these power state transitions can occur over short intervals. As a result, entering and exiting to and from an active state to a deep idle state can involve transitioning media (i.e., copying data from volatile memory to non-volatile memory) with energy and thermal consumption. For example, following the transition of a conventional memory sub-system from an active state to the sleep state resulting in the transitioning of media, power consumption (e.g., as a function of a standby current), an increase of required thermal power, and corresponding entry and exit latencies, the host system can send a command to the memory sub-system producing a transition back to the active state. In this example, inefficiencies are produced by the transition to the deep idle state and rapid return transition to the active state.

(14) In an approach, a standby circuit is employed to supply an internal voltage level to the memory device during the sleep mode. The standby circuit includes a bandgap circuit coupled to a voltage regulator and detector component (herein referred to as a “voltage regulator”). The bandgap circuit is used to supply the voltage regulator with power to enable the voltage regulator to regulate a power supply voltage level (e.g., from 3.6V to 2.25V) and generate an output voltage level (herein a “voltage regulator level” or “Vr”) and a standby current level ($I_{sub.SB}$) to supply to the memory device and detect standby power during the sleep mode.

(15) This results in a high standby current associated with the internal voltage level generated by the voltage regulator and the consumption of current by the bandgap circuit. To address these issues, in this approach, the standby current is reduced during the sleep mode by powering off a power supply of the memory sub-system (e.g., an internal battery powering the components of the memory sub-system). However, powering off the power supply results in significant longer entry and exit latency times and a reduction in reliability of the data stored by the memory device. In addition, the impact of the longer entry and exit latency times associated with powering down the power supply during the sleep mode is amplified by the increasing level of processing of frequent high-level data bursts (e.g., data bursts while a user watches a movie) that require a wake-up

transition (e.g., waking up from the sleep mode (PS4) to an active mode). Disadvantageously, the supplying of voltage to the bandgap component by the power supply results in significant leakage current (e.g., from a controller) when the memory device is in the sleep state (e.g., PS4).

(16) Aspects of the present disclosure address the above and other deficiencies by implementing a low power mode to provide a reference voltage to a voltage regulator to regulate and reduce a standby current consumed during operation of a memory device in an idle or sleep power state, while maintaining a power supply (e.g., a “first power supply” or “internal power supply”) in a powered on state during the low power mode.

(17) In an embodiment, a low power mode component is employed to manage entry and exit into the low power mode. In the low power mode, a bandgap circuit is powered down or shut off to disable consumption of current by the bandgap circuit. In an embodiment, the low power mode component controls the operation of a circuit (herein referred to as a “low power mode circuit”) to provide a reference voltage level to the voltage regulator. The supplied reference voltage level (also referred to as a “low power mode reference voltage” or “Vref-lpm”) enables the voltage regulator to produce an output voltage (also referred to as “Vreg”). Advantageously, supply of the lower level reference voltage by the low power mode circuit to the voltage regulator results in a lower voltage regulator output voltage and a reduction of a standby current (e.g., reduced to a level of 5 μ A or less) during the sleep mode of the memory sub-system. A further advantage is achieved by establishing the low power mode while maintaining operation of the power supply to reduce an exit latency associated with the transition of the memory sub-system from the sleep power state (e.g., PS4) to an active state (e.g., PS0). In addition, maintaining the power supply on avoids the loss of data reliability by eliminating the power cycling of the power supply. Furthermore, a life of the power supply (e.g., an internal battery) is improved by keeping the power supply on during the sleep mode by reducing power cycles and corresponding initialization processing.

(18) FIG. 1 illustrates an example computing system **100** that includes a memory sub-system **110** in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The memory sub-system **110** can include media, such as one or more volatile memory devices (e.g., memory device **140**), one or more non-volatile memory devices (e.g., memory device **130**), or a combination of such.

(19) A memory sub-system **110** can be a storage device, a memory module, or a hybrid of a storage device and memory module. Examples of a storage device include a solid-state drive (SSD), a flash drive, a universal serial bus (USB) flash drive, an embedded Multi-Media Controller (eMMC) drive, a Universal Flash Storage (UFS) drive, a secure digital (SD) card, and a hard disk drive (HDD). Examples of memory modules include a dual in-line memory module (DIMM), a small outline DIMM (SO-DIMM), and various types of non-volatile dual in-line memory module (NVDIMM).

(20) The computing system **100** can be a computing device such as a desktop computer, laptop computer, network server, mobile device, a vehicle (e.g., airplane, drone, train, automobile, or other conveyance), Internet of Things (IoT) enabled device, embedded computer (e.g., one included in a vehicle, industrial equipment, or a networked commercial device), or such computing device that includes memory and a processing device.

(21) The computing system **100** can include a host system **120** that is coupled to one or more memory sub-systems **110**. In some embodiments, the host system **120** is coupled to different types of memory sub-system **110**. FIG. 1 illustrates one example of a host system **120** coupled to one memory sub-system **110**. As used herein, “coupled to” or “coupled with” generally refers to a connection between components, which can be an indirect communicative connection or direct communicative connection (e.g., without intervening components), whether wired or wireless, including connections such as electrical, optical, magnetic, etc.

(22) The host system **120** can include a processor chipset and a software stack executed by the processor chipset. The processor chipset can include one or more cores, one or more caches, a memory controller (e.g., NVDIMM controller), and a storage protocol controller (e.g., PCIe

controller, SATA controller). The host system **120** uses the memory sub-system **110**, for example, to write data to the memory sub-system **110** and read data from the memory sub-system **110**.

(23) The host system **120** can be coupled to the memory sub-system **110** via a physical host interface. Examples of a physical host interface include, but are not limited to, a serial advanced technology attachment (SATA) interface, a peripheral component interconnect express (PCIe) interface, universal serial bus (USB) interface, Fibre Channel, Serial Attached SCSI (SAS), a double data rate (DDR) memory bus, Small Computer System Interface (SCSI), a dual in-line memory module (DIMM) interface (e.g., DIMM socket interface that supports Double Data Rate (DDR)), etc. The physical host interface can be used to transmit data between the host system **120** and the memory sub-system **110**. The host system **120** can further utilize an NVM Express (NVMe) interface to access components (e.g., memory devices **130**) when the memory sub-system **110** is coupled with the host system **120** by the PCIe interface. The physical host interface can provide an interface for passing control, address, data, and other signals between the memory sub-system **110** and the host system **120**. FIG. 1 illustrates a memory sub-system **110** as an example. In general, the host system **120** can access multiple memory sub-systems via a same communication connection, multiple separate communication connections, and/or a combination of communication connections.

(24) The memory devices **130,140** can include any combination of the different types of non-volatile memory devices and/or volatile memory devices. The volatile memory devices (e.g., memory device **140**) can be, but are not limited to, random access memory (RAM), such as dynamic random access memory (DRAM) and synchronous dynamic random access memory (SDRAM).

(25) Some examples of non-volatile memory devices (e.g., memory device **130**) include a negative-and (NAND) type flash memory and write-in-place memory, such as a three-dimensional cross-point (“3D cross-point”) memory device, which is a cross-point array of non-volatile memory cells. A cross-point array of non-volatile memory can perform bit storage based on a change of bulk resistance, in conjunction with a stackable cross-gridded data access array. Additionally, in contrast to many flash-based memories, cross-point non-volatile memory can perform a write in-place operation, where a non-volatile memory cell can be programmed without the non-volatile memory cell being previously erased. NAND type flash memory includes, for example, two-dimensional NAND (2D NAND) and three-dimensional NAND (3D NAND).

(26) Each of the memory devices **130** can include one or more arrays of memory cells. One type of memory cell, for example, single level cells (SLC) can store one bit per cell. Other types of memory cells, such as multi-level cells (MLCs), triple level cells (TLCs), and quad-level cells (QLCs), can store multiple bits per cell. In some embodiments, each of the memory devices **130** can include one or more arrays of memory cells such as SLCs, MLCs, TLCs, QLCs, or any combination of such. In some embodiments, a particular memory device can include an SLC portion, and an MLC portion, a TLC portion, or a QLC portion of memory cells. The memory cells of the memory devices **130** can be grouped as pages that can refer to a logical unit of the memory device used to store data. With some types of memory (e.g., NAND), pages can be grouped to form blocks.

(27) Although non-volatile memory components such as 3D cross-point array of non-volatile memory cells and NAND type flash memory (e.g., 2D NAND, 3D NAND) are described, the memory device **130** can be based on any other type of non-volatile memory, such as read-only memory (ROM), phase change memory (PCM), self-selecting memory, other chalcogenide based memories, ferroelectric transistor random-access memory (FeTRAM), ferroelectric random access memory (FeRAM), magneto random access memory (MRAM), Spin Transfer Torque (STT)-MRAM, conductive bridging RAM (CBRAM), resistive random access memory (RRAM), oxide based RRAM (OxRAM), negative-or (NOR) flash memory, and electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM).

(28) A memory sub-system controller **115** (or controller **115** for simplicity) can communicate with the memory devices **130** to perform operations such as reading data, writing data, or erasing data at the memory devices **130** and other such operations. The memory sub-system controller **115** can include hardware such as one or more integrated circuits and/or discrete components, a buffer memory, or a combination thereof. The hardware can include a digital circuitry with dedicated (i.e., hard-coded) logic to perform the operations described herein. The memory sub-system controller **115** can be a microcontroller, special purpose logic circuitry (e.g., a field programmable gate array (FPGA), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), etc.), or other suitable processor.

(29) The memory sub-system controller **115** can include a processor **117** (e.g., processing device) configured to execute instructions stored in a local memory **119**. In the illustrated example, the local memory **119** of the memory sub-system controller **115** includes an embedded memory configured to store instructions for performing various processes, operations, logic flows, and routines that control operation of the memory sub-system **110**, including handling communications between the memory sub-system **110** and the host system **120**.

(30) In some embodiments, the local memory **119** can include memory registers storing memory pointers, fetched data, etc. The local memory **119** can also include read-only memory (ROM) for storing micro-code. While the example memory sub-system **110** in FIG. **1** has been illustrated as including the memory sub-system controller **115**, in another embodiment of the present disclosure, a memory sub-system **110** does not include a memory sub-system controller **115**, and can instead rely upon external control (e.g., provided by an external host, or by a processor or controller separate from the memory sub-system).

(31) In general, the memory sub-system controller **115** can receive commands or operations from the host system **120** and can convert the commands or operations into instructions or appropriate commands to achieve the desired access to the memory devices **130**. The memory sub-system controller **115** can be responsible for other operations such as wear leveling operations, garbage collection operations, error detection and error-correcting code (ECC) operations, encryption operations, caching operations, and address translations between a logical block address (e.g., logical block address (LBA), namespace) and a physical block address (e.g., physical block address) that are associated with the memory devices **130**. The memory sub-system controller **115** can further include host interface circuitry to communicate with the host system **120** via the physical host interface. The host interface circuitry can convert the commands received from the host system **120** into command instructions to access the memory devices **130** as well as convert responses associated with the memory devices **130** into information for the host system **120**.

(32) The memory sub-system **110** can also include additional circuitry or components that are not illustrated. In some embodiments, the memory sub-system **110** can include a cache or buffer (e.g., DRAM) and address circuitry (e.g., a row decoder and a column decoder) that can receive an address from the memory sub-system controller **115** and decode the address to access the memory devices **130**.

(33) In some embodiments, the memory devices **130** include local media controllers **135** that operate in conjunction with memory sub-system controller **115** to execute operations on one or more memory cells of the memory devices **130**. An external controller (e.g., memory sub-system controller **115**) can externally manage the memory device **130** (e.g., perform media management operations on the memory device **140**, **130**). In some embodiments, a memory device **130** is a managed memory device, which includes a raw memory device **130** having control logic (e.g., local media controller **135**) on the die and a controller (e.g., memory sub-system controller **115**) for media management within the same memory device package. An example of a managed memory device is a managed NAND (MNAND) device.

(34) The memory sub-system **110** includes a low power mode management component **113** to manage the operation of a low power mode standby circuit to supply a managed standby current level to the memory device **130** during sleep mode operation (e.g., an idle or sleep state) of the

memory sub-system **110**. In an embodiment, the low power mode management component **113** initiates entry into the low power mode to cause a reference voltage level to be supplied by a low power mode reference voltage generator to a voltage regulator while a power supply of the memory sub-system is maintained in a powered state (e.g., an internal power supply, such as a battery of the memory sub-system, remains on). The low power mode reference voltage level (or V.sub.REF-LPM) causes the voltage regulator to generate an output voltage to supply to the memory device **130** at a reduced standby current level (e.g., 1.8 μ A), resulting in a reduced power consumption level. In addition, an improved exit latency (e.g., 125 μ s) is achieved by establishing the low power mode while keeping the power supply on to enable the parallel wake-up transition of memory dies of the memory device **140, 130** from the sleep mode to an active mode.

(35) In some embodiments, the local media controller **135** includes at least a portion of the low power mode management component **113**. For example, the local media controller **135** can initiate command or signals to control a low power mode standby circuit **137** for performing the operations described herein.

(36) FIG. 2 is a simplified block diagram of a first apparatus, in the form of a memory device **130**, in communication with a second apparatus, in the form of a memory sub-system controller **115** of a memory sub-system (e.g., memory sub-system **110** of FIG. 1), according to an embodiment. Some examples of electronic systems include personal computers, personal digital assistants (PDAs), digital cameras, digital media players, digital recorders, games, appliances, vehicles, wireless devices, mobile telephones and the like. The memory sub-system controller **115** (e.g., a controller external to the memory device **130** of FIG. 1), may be a memory controller or other external host device.

(37) Memory device **130** includes an array of memory cells **204** logically arranged in rows and columns. Memory cells of a logical row are typically connected to the same access line (e.g., a word line) while memory cells of a logical column are typically selectively connected to the same data line (e.g., a bit line). A single access line may be associated with more than one logical row of memory cells and a single data line may be associated with more than one logical column. Memory cells (not shown in FIG. 2) of at least a portion of array of memory cells **204** are capable of being programmed to one of at least two target data states.

(38) Row decode circuitry **208** and column decode circuitry **210** are provided to decode address signals. Address signals are received and decoded to access the array of memory cells **204**.

Memory device **130** also includes input/output (I/O) control circuitry **212** to manage input of commands, addresses and data to the memory device **130** as well as output of data and status information from the memory device **130**. An address register **214** is in communication with I/O control circuitry **212** and row decode circuitry **208** and column decode circuitry **210** to latch the address signals prior to decoding. A command register **224** is in communication with I/O control circuitry **212** and control logic **216** to latch incoming commands.

(39) A controller (e.g., the local media controller **135** internal to the memory device **130**) controls access to the array of memory cells **204** in response to the commands and generates status information for the external memory sub-system controller **115**, i.e., the local media controller **135** is configured to perform access operations (e.g., read operations, programming operations and/or erase operations) on the array of memory cells **204**. The local media controller **135** is in communication with row decode circuitry **208** and column decode circuitry **210** to control the row decode circuitry **208** and column decode circuitry **210** in response to the addresses.

(40) The local media controller **135** is also in communication with a cache register **218**. Cache register **218** latches data, either incoming or outgoing, as directed by the local media controller **135** to temporarily store data while the array of memory cells **204** is busy writing or reading, respectively, other data. During a programming operation (e.g., write operation), data may be passed from the cache register **218** to the data register **220** for transfer to the array of memory cells **204**; then new data may be latched in the cache register **218** from the I/O control circuitry **212**.

During a read operation, data may be passed from the cache register **218** to the I/O control circuitry **212** for output to the memory sub-system controller **115**; then new data may be passed from the data register **220** to the cache register **218**. The cache register **218** and/or the data register **220** may form (e.g., may form a portion of) a page buffer of the memory device **130**. A page buffer may further include sensing devices (not shown in FIG. 2) to sense a data state of a memory cell of the array of memory cells **204**, e.g., by sensing a state of a data line connected to that memory cell. A status register **222** may be in communication with I/O control circuitry **212** and the local memory controller **135** to latch the status information for output to the memory sub-system controller **115**. In an embodiment, the local media controller **135** includes a low power mode management component **113** to perform operations and functions as described in detail herein.

(41) Memory device **130** receives control signals at the memory sub-system controller **115** from the local media controller **135** over a control link **232**. For example, the control signals may include a chip enable CE #, a command latch enable CLE, an address latch enable ALE, a write enable WE #, a read enable RE #, and a write protect WP #. Additional or alternative control signals (not shown) may be further received over control link **232** depending upon the nature of the memory device **130**. Memory device **130** receives command signals (which represent commands), address signals (which represent addresses), and data signals (which represent data) from the memory sub-system controller **115** over a multiplexed input/output (I/O) bus **234** and outputs data to the memory sub-system controller **115** over I/O bus **234**.

(42) For example, the commands may be received over input/output (I/O) pins [7:0] of I/O bus **234** at I/O control circuitry **212** and may then be written into command register **224**. The addresses may be received over input/output (I/O) pins [7:0] of I/O bus **234** at I/O control circuitry **212** and may then be written into address register **214**. The data may be received over input/output (I/O) pins [7:0] for an 8-bit device or input/output (I/O) pins [15:0] for a 16-bit device at I/O control circuitry **212** and then may be written into cache register **218**. The data may be subsequently written into data register **220** for programming the array of memory cells **204**.

(43) In an embodiment, cache register **218** may be omitted, and the data may be written directly into data register **220**. Data may also be output over input/output (I/O) pins [7:0] for an 8-bit device or input/output (I/O) pins [15:0] for a 16-bit device. Although reference may be made to I/O pins, they may include any conductive node providing for electrical connection to the memory device **130** by an external device (e.g., the memory sub-system controller **115**), such as conductive pads or conductive bumps as are commonly used.

(44) It will be appreciated by those skilled in the art that additional circuitry and signals can be provided, and that the memory device **130** of FIG. 2 has been simplified. It should be recognized that the functionality of the various block components described with reference to FIG. 2 may not necessarily be segregated to distinct components or component portions of an integrated circuit device. For example, a single component or component portion of an integrated circuit device could be adapted to perform the functionality of more than one block component of FIG. 2. Alternatively, one or more components or component portions of an integrated circuit device could be combined to perform the functionality of a single block component of FIG. 2.

(45) Additionally, while specific I/O pins are described in accordance with popular conventions for receipt and output of the various signals, it is noted that other combinations or numbers of I/O pins (or other I/O node structures) may be used in the various embodiments.

(46) FIG. 3 illustrates an example controller **135** including a low power mode management component **113** configured to initiate commands or signals to control a low power mode standby circuit **300** to supply a standby current to a memory device **130** during operation in a sleep state (e.g., PS4). In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 3, the low power mode standby circuit **300** includes a low power mode reference voltage generator **315**. In response to a command from the low power mode management component **113**, the low power mode reference voltage generator **315** is turned on (e.g., action **316**) and generates a low power mode reference voltage (V.sub.REF-

LPM) that is supplied to a voltage regulator **360**. In an embodiment, the low power mode reference voltage is set to a level (e.g., 1.6V) to enable the voltage regulator **360** to generate a corresponding output voltage level (V.sub.reg) (e.g., 1.6V) to supply to the memory device.

(47) In an embodiment, the low power mode management component **113** turns off the bandgap circuit **320** (e.g., action **321**) of the low power mode standby circuit **300** when operating in the low power mode. By turning off the bandgap circuit, a lower level of standby current is consumed in connection with powering the memory device **130** during the sleep state.

(48) In an embodiment, during the low power mode initiated by the low power mode management component **113**, the power supply **350** (e.g., a battery associated with the memory sub-system) remains on (e.g., the power supply is maintained in a powered state). Advantageously, keeping the power supply **350** on enables a lower entry and exit latencies and improved reliability of the memory device **130** by avoiding power cycling (e.g., as experienced by a typical system that turns the power supply off when the memory device is in the sleep mode).

(49) In an embodiment, control of the low power mode standby circuit **300** by the low power mode management component **113** as shown in FIG. 3 results in a low standby current consumption level (e.g., 5 μ A or less). In addition, the low power mode management component **113** causing entry into the low power mode while the power supply **350** remains on resulting in a reduced exit latency associated with transitioning the memory device **130** from the sleep state to an active state (e.g., latency levels of approximately 125 μ s). Furthermore, keeping the power supply **350** on during the low power mode and entry into the sleep state reduces the number of power cycles of the power supply **350** which decreases read disturb concerns (e.g., increases reliability) and improves the life of the power supply **350** (e.g., due to fewer power cycles and initialization processing).

(50) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram of an example method **400** to manage a standby current level supplied to a memory device of a memory sub-system during an idle or sleep power state, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. The method **400** can be performed by processing logic that can include hardware (e.g., processing device, circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, hardware of a device, integrated circuit, etc.), software (e.g., instructions run or executed on a processing device), or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the method **400** is performed by the low power mode management component **113** of FIGS. 1-3.

(51) At operation **410**, a determination is made. For example, the processing logic (e.g., the low power mode management component **113**) determines whether a memory device of a memory sub-system is to be transitioned to a sleep mode or sleep state (e.g., an idle power state) or remain in an active state. In an embodiment, the sleep state is an idle power state during which the memory device is inactive and has a reduced power consumption level. In an embodiment, the transition to the sleep state can be determined by confirming an outstanding workload (e.g., a set of requested operations stored in a workload queue for processing by the memory device) is completed. In an embodiment, transition to the sleep mode can be determined by confirming the memory device is in an active idle state. In an embodiment, the memory sub-system can be transition from a power state associated with an active mode (e.g., a power level required to execute a workload) to an active idle state wherein no further operations are to be performed (e.g., the memory device is idle). In an embodiment, the memory sub-system can remain in the active idle state for a duration of time before it can be transitioned to a lower power state.

(52) In operation **420**, a command is initiated. For example, the processing logic initiates a command to cause a standby circuit associated with the memory device to enter into a low power mode while a power supply of the memory sub-system is on. In an embodiment, the power supply (e.g., an internal battery of the memory sub-system) remains on during entry and operation in the low power mode. In an embodiment, the standby circuit includes a component (e.g., the low power mode reference voltage generator **315** of FIG. 3) coupled to a voltage regulator that supplies a regulated output voltage to the memory device during the sleep mode operation. In an embodiment,

the command to enter into the low power mode causes the component to turn on.

(53) In operation **430**, a voltage is supplied. For example, when the memory device is in the low power mode, the processing logic causes a reference voltage (e.g., $V_{\text{sub.REF-LPM}}$ of FIG. 2) to be supplied to a voltage regulator (e.g., voltage regulator **360** of FIG. 3) of the standby circuit (e.g., low power mode standby circuit **300** of FIG. 3). Using the reference voltage, the voltage regulator generates a regulated output voltage level (e.g., V_{reg} of FIG. 3) to the memory device (e.g., memory device **130** of FIG. 3). The regulated voltage level supplied to the memory device is reduced or regulated to match the reference voltage level (e.g., approximately 1.6V). The use of the reference voltage level results in the generation of a reduced standby current level (e.g., approximately 5 μA or less) for consumption by the memory device during the sleep mode operation.

(54) In an embodiment, entry into the low power mode can include turning off a bandgap circuit (e.g., bandgap circuit **320** of FIG. 3) of the standby circuit and turning on the reference voltage generator (e.g., low power mode reference voltage generator **315** of FIG. 3). Advantageously, supplying the voltage regulator with the reference voltage from the low power mode reference voltage generator enables a reduction in the standby leakage current, while the power supply remains powered on.

(55) In an embodiment, the memory sub-system can transition from the sleep mode operation into an active power state (e.g., in response to activity or operations requests from a host system for performance by the memory device). Advantageously, since in the low power mode the power supply remains powered on, the exit latency (e.g., exiting the sleep mode) is reduced to lower level (e.g., 150 μs) as compared to typical systems that turn the power supply off when in the sleep mode. Furthermore, keeping the power supply on in the lower power mode of the sleep mode operation reduces a number of power cycles and initialization cycles by the power supply, which increases a length of a lifecycle of the power supply.

(56) FIG. 5 illustrates an example low power mode management component **113** for generating a regulated standby current level for sleep mode operation of a memory sub-system including a first power supply and a second power supply (e.g., an external power supply associated with the memory sub-system), according to embodiments. In FIG. 5, the low power mode management component **113** generates a low power mode command signal to transition a standby circuit into low power mode while both the first power supply and the second power supply remain on. As shown in FIG. 5, the first power supply remains powered on and supplies a first power supply voltage level ($V_{\text{sub.PS1}}$) (e.g., approximately 2.35V to 3.6V, shown as 2.5V in the example shown in FIG. 5) during operation in the low power mode. In the embodiment shown in FIG. 5, the second power supply remains powered on and supplies a second power supply voltage level ($V_{\text{sub.PS2}}$) during operation in the low power mode.

(57) In an embodiment, the low power mode management component **113** issues a command signal (e.g., a low power mode command signal **515**) for entry into the low power mode of the sleep mode operation. In an embodiment, the command signal **515** can be issued in response to a determination that no pending workload (e.g., requested operations associated with the memory device) is pending and the memory sub-system is in an active idle state. In an embodiment, a time period ($T_{\text{sub.LPM-Entry}}$) (e.g., less than 25 μs) can be used to enable the memory sub-system to stabilize when the second power supply is on. In an embodiment, in the low power mode, a reference voltage generator is switched on to supply a reference voltage (e.g., $V_{\text{sub.REF-LPM}}$) to the voltage regulator to generate the voltage regulator output ($V_{\text{sub.REG}}$). As shown in FIG. 5, the $V_{\text{sub.REF-LPM}}$ and corresponding $V_{\text{sub.REG}}$ are set to a reduced level (e.g., 1.6V) during operation in the lower power mode **550**, which results in a managed standby current level (e.g., approximately 5 μs or less). As shown in FIG. 5, the first power supply and the second power supply remain on during the low power mode operation **550**.

(58) In an embodiment, the memory sub-system can be transitioned from the lower power mode

(e.g., exited from the low power mode of the sleep mode operation) in response to the falling edge of the low power mode command signal **515**. In an embodiment, a time period (T.sub.LPM-Exit) (e.g., less than 100 μ s) can be used to enable the memory sub-system to stabilize when the second power supply is on. In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 5, the internal voltage level (e.g., V.sub.REG) supplied to the memory device can be ramped up from the low power mode **550** level (e.g., 1.6V) to a threshold or normal operating level (e.g., 2.25V). In an embodiment, a reset command can be sent following the T.sub.LPM-Exit time period to clear the low power mode setting. In an embodiment, at this stage, the memory device is in an active mode and ready to process operations, without the need to perform a trim loading process.

(59) FIG. 6 illustrates an example low power mode management component **113** for generating a regulated standby current level for sleep mode operation of a memory sub-system including a first power supply and a second power supply (e.g., an external power supply associated with the memory sub-system), according to embodiments. In FIG. 6, the low power mode management component **113** generates a low power mode command signal to transition a standby circuit into low power mode while the first power supply is powered on and the second power supply executes a power cycle. As shown in FIG. 6, the first power supply remains powered on and supplies a first power supply voltage level (V.sub.PS1) (e.g., approximately 2.35V to 3.6V, shown as 2.5V in the example shown in FIG. 6) during operation in the low power mode. In the embodiment shown in FIG. 6, the second power supply experiences a power cycle wherein the second power supply transitions from a powered on mode (e.g., supplying a V.sub.PS2 of 1.2V) to a powered off mode (e.g., supplying a V.sub.PS2 of 0V).

(60) In an embodiment, entry into the low mode occurs when no pending workload (e.g., requested operations associated with the memory device) is pending and the memory sub-system is in an active idle state. In an embodiment, the low power mode command causes the second power supply to initiate a powering down operation causing a ramping down of the V.sub.PS2 voltage. In an embodiment, the memory device can be switched to the low power mode (e.g., the low power mode component can supply the reference voltage to the voltage regulator to generate the V.sub.REF-LPM level supplied to the memory device) following the powering down of the second power supply.

(61) In an embodiment, the memory sub-system can be transitioned from the lower power mode (e.g., exited from the low power mode of the sleep mode operation) when the second power supply is powered off. In an embodiment, a controller of the memory sub-system can be used to restore the second power supply to a powered on mode. In an embodiment, a voltage detector can be used to restore the memory device to a normal standby mode of operation. In an embodiment, a delay (e.g., a delay of 50 μ s or less to exit the low power mode and stabilize the memory sub-system when the second power supplied is powered off. In an embodiment, as shown in FIG. 6, the internal voltage (e.g., V.sub.REG) supplied to the memory device can be ramped up from the low power mode **650** level (e.g., 1.6V) to a threshold or normal operating level (e.g., 2.25V). In an embodiment, a reset command can be sent to clear the low power mode setting. In an embodiment, at this stage, the memory device is placed in an active mode and ready to process operations, without the need to perform a trim loading process.

(62) FIG. 7 illustrates an example machine of a computer system **700** within which a set of instructions, for causing the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein, can be executed. In some embodiments, the computer system **700** can correspond to a host system (e.g., the host system **120** of FIG. 1) that includes, is coupled to, or utilizes a memory sub-system (e.g., the memory sub-system **110** of FIG. 1) or can be used to perform the operations of a controller (e.g., to execute an operating system to perform operations corresponding to the low power mode management component **113** of FIG. 1). In alternative embodiments, the machine can be connected (e.g., networked) to other machines in a LAN, an intranet, an extranet, and/or the Internet. The machine can operate in the capacity of a server or a client machine in client-server

network environment, as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment, or as a server or a client machine in a cloud computing infrastructure or environment.

(63) The machine can be a personal computer (PC), a tablet PC, a set-top box (STB), a Personal Digital Assistant (PDA), a cellular telephone, a web appliance, a server, a network router, a switch or bridge, or any machine capable of executing a set of instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify actions to be taken by that machine. Further, while a single machine is illustrated, the term “machine” shall also be taken to include any collection of machines that individually or jointly execute a set (or multiple sets) of instructions to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

(64) The example computer system **700** includes a processing device **702**, a main memory **704** (e.g., read-only memory (ROM), flash memory, dynamic random access memory (DRAM) such as synchronous DRAM (SDRAM) or Rambus DRAM (RDRAM), etc.), a static memory **706** (e.g., flash memory, static random access memory (SRAM), etc.), and a data storage system **718**, which communicate with each other via a bus **730**.

(65) Processing device **702** represents one or more general-purpose processing devices such as a microprocessor, a central processing unit, or the like. More particularly, the processing device can be a complex instruction set computing (CISC) microprocessor, reduced instruction set computing (RISC) microprocessor, very long instruction word (VLIW) microprocessor, or a processor implementing other instruction sets, or processors implementing a combination of instruction sets. Processing device **702** can also be one or more special-purpose processing devices such as an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a field programmable gate array (FPGA), a digital signal processor (DSP), network processor, or the like. The processing device **702** is configured to execute instructions **726** for performing the operations and steps discussed herein. The computer system **700** can further include a network interface device **708** to communicate over the network **720**.

(66) The data storage system **718** can include a machine-readable storage medium **724** (also known as a computer-readable medium) on which is stored one or more sets of instructions **726** or software embodying any one or more of the methodologies or functions described herein. The instructions **726** can also reside, completely or at least partially, within the main memory **704** and/or within the processing device **702** during execution thereof by the computer system **700**, the main memory **704** and the processing device **702** also constituting machine-readable storage media. The machine-readable storage medium **724**, data storage system **718**, and/or main memory **704** can correspond to the memory sub-system **110** of FIG. 1.

(67) In one embodiment, the instructions **726** include instructions to implement functionality corresponding to a selective relocation component (e.g., the low power mode management component **113** of FIG. 1). While the machine-readable storage medium **724** is shown in an example embodiment to be a single medium, the term “machine-readable storage medium” should be taken to include a single medium or multiple media that store the one or more sets of instructions. The term “machine-readable storage medium” shall also be taken to include any medium that is capable of storing or encoding a set of instructions for execution by the machine and that cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies of the present disclosure. The term “machine-readable storage medium” shall accordingly be taken to include, but not be limited to, solid-state memories, optical media, and magnetic media.

(68) Some portions of the preceding detailed descriptions have been presented in terms of algorithms and symbolic representations of operations on data bits within a computer memory. These algorithmic descriptions and representations are the ways used by those skilled in the data processing arts to most effectively convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. An algorithm is here, and generally, conceived to be a self-consistent sequence of operations leading to a desired result. The operations are those requiring physical manipulations of physical quantities. Usually, though not necessarily, these quantities take the form of electrical or magnetic

signals capable of being stored, combined, compared, and otherwise manipulated. It has proven convenient at times, principally for reasons of common usage, to refer to these signals as bits, values, elements, symbols, characters, terms, numbers, or the like.

(69) It should be borne in mind, however, that all of these and similar terms are to be associated with the appropriate physical quantities and are merely convenient labels applied to these quantities. The present disclosure can refer to the action and processes of a computer system, or similar electronic computing device, that manipulates and transforms data represented as physical (electronic) quantities within the computer system's registers and memories into other data similarly represented as physical quantities within the computer system memories or registers or other such information storage systems.

(70) The present disclosure also relates to an apparatus for performing the operations herein. This apparatus can be specially constructed for the intended purposes, or it can include a general purpose computer selectively activated or reconfigured by a computer program stored in the computer. Such a computer program can be stored in a computer readable storage medium, such as, but not limited to, any type of disk including floppy disks, optical disks, CD-ROMs, and magnetic-optical disks, read-only memories (ROMs), random access memories (RAMs), EPROMs, EEPROMs, magnetic or optical cards, or any type of media suitable for storing electronic instructions, each coupled to a computer system bus.

(71) The algorithms and displays presented herein are not inherently related to any particular computer or other apparatus. Various general purpose systems can be used with programs in accordance with the teachings herein, or it can prove convenient to construct a more specialized apparatus to perform the method. The structure for a variety of these systems will appear as set forth in the description below. In addition, the present disclosure is not described with reference to any particular programming language. It will be appreciated that a variety of programming languages can be used to implement the teachings of the disclosure as described herein.

(72) The present disclosure can be provided as a computer program product, or software, that can include a machine-readable medium having stored thereon instructions, which can be used to program a computer system (or other electronic devices) to perform a process according to the present disclosure. A machine-readable medium includes any mechanism for storing information in a form readable by a machine (e.g., a computer). In some embodiments, a machine-readable (e.g., computer-readable) medium includes a machine (e.g., a computer) readable storage medium such as a read only memory ("ROM"), random access memory ("RAM"), magnetic disk storage media, optical storage media, flash memory components, etc.

(73) In the foregoing specification, embodiments of the disclosure have been described with reference to specific example embodiments thereof. It will be evident that various modifications can be made thereto without departing from the broader spirit and scope of embodiments of the disclosure as set forth in the following claims. The specification and drawings are, accordingly, to be regarded in an illustrative sense rather than a restrictive sense.

Claims

1. A memory sub-system comprising: a standby circuit comprising a voltage regulator operatively coupled to a memory device; and control logic, operatively coupled to the standby circuit, to perform operations comprising: causing the standby circuit associated with the memory device to enter into a low power mode; and in the low power mode, causing a reference voltage to be supplied to the voltage regulator, wherein the reference voltage causes the voltage regulator to generate a regulated output voltage supplied to the memory device resulting in generation of a standby current level that is lower than a current level supplied to the memory device when the memory device is in an active mode.
2. The memory sub-system of claim 1, wherein the memory device is maintained in a powered state

during the low power mode.

3. The memory sub-system of claim 1, wherein the memory device is in a sleep mode during supply of the standby current level.

4. The memory sub-system of claim 1, wherein the regulated output voltage is limited based on the reference voltage.

5. The memory sub-system of claim 1, wherein the standby current level is limited based on the reference voltage.

6. The memory sub-system of claim 1, the operations further comprising: in the low power mode, disabling supplying an output of a bandgap circuit of the standby circuit to the voltage regulator.

7. The memory sub-system of claim 1, the operations further comprising initiating an exit from the low power mode to transition the memory device from a sleep mode to the active mode.

8. A memory device comprising: an array of memory cells coupled to a first circuit comprising a voltage regulator; and control logic, operatively coupled with the first circuit, to perform operations comprising: causing the first circuit to enter into a low power mode; and in the low power mode, causing a reference voltage to be supplied to the voltage regulator, wherein the reference voltage causes the voltage regulator to generate a regulated output voltage supplied to the memory device resulting in generation of a first current level that is lower than a current level supplied to the memory device when the memory device is in an active mode.

9. The memory device of claim 8, wherein the memory device is maintained in a powered state during the low power mode.

10. The memory device of claim 8, wherein the memory device is in a sleep mode during supply of the first current level.

11. The memory device of claim 8, wherein the regulated output voltage is limited based on the reference voltage.

12. The memory device of claim 8, wherein the first current level is limited based on the reference voltage.

13. The memory device of claim 8, the operations further comprising: in the low power mode, disabling supplying an output of a bandgap circuit of the first circuit to the voltage regulator.

14. The memory device of claim 8, the operations further comprising initiating an exit from the low power mode to transition the memory device from a sleep mode to the active mode.

15. A method comprising: causing, by a processing device of a memory sub-system, a standby circuit associated with a memory device to enter into a low power mode; and in the low power mode, causing a reference voltage to be supplied to a voltage regulator, wherein the reference voltage causes the voltage regulator to generate a regulated output voltage supplied to the memory device resulting in generation of a standby current level that is lower than a current level supplied to the memory device when the memory device is in an active mode.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the regulated output voltage is limited based on the reference voltage.

17. The method of claim 15, further comprising maintaining the memory device in a powered state during the low power mode.

18. The method of claim 15, wherein the memory device is in a sleep mode during supply of the standby current level.

19. The method of claim 15, wherein the standby current level is limited based on the reference voltage.

20. The method of claim 15, further comprising in the low power mode, disabling supplying an output of a bandgap circuit of the standby circuit to the voltage regulator.
